



11-15-2022 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xu246LnED4I
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Muncie Community Schools Board of Education Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: November 15, 2022 (Estimated based on chronological context and transcript references)

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

(No statutory public hearing or separate committee work session was held immediately prior to the regular meeting call to order.)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** 00:01:31 The meeting was called to order at 5:00 PM by the presiding officer (Board President Mr. Byrne). Opening proceedings included a moment of silence.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Dr. O'Neill, Mr. Heater, Mrs. Bales, Mrs. Barnes Griffin, Mr. Irvin, Mr. Low, and President Byrne.
 - **Members Absent:** None noted.

- **Presiding Officer:** President Byrne.
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3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Opening moment of silence [00:01:40](#). Special recognition of Jim Williams, who was presented with the **Sagamore of the Wabash** award on behalf of Governor Eric Holcomb by Dr. Kwiatkowski [00:03:08](#).
 - **Approval of Minutes:** Approved by voice vote, with a minor correction noted by a board member regarding attendance status [01:36:45](#).
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

[00:11:52](#) Westview Elementary School Presentation & Updates

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Eric Ambler, Principal; joined by Mr. Hendershot (Project Lead the Way teacher).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Principal Ambler presented operational updates for Westview Elementary, noting an enrollment growth to 492<U+2013>499 students, making it the largest elementary school by population in Muncie Community Schools. Highlights included the expansion of the K-5 Spanish Immersion dual-language program (serving 133 students, roughly 26-27%), low staff attrition due to a positive school culture, and the implementation of academic vocabulary strategies. Mr. Hendershot reviewed the **Project Lead the Way (PLTW)** STEM modules implemented across grades 1 through 5, highlighting hands-on science and engineering curricula.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; no board vote required.

[01:01:52](#) Civic Renewal through Education, Tolerance, and Engagement (CREATE) Grant Update

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. Wolf.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Dr. Wolf presented an overview of the "CREATE" project<U+2014>a \$1.5 million, 3-year federal grant (under the Every Student Succeeds Act) in partnership with Ball State University. The initiative focuses on enhancing civic knowledge, skills, and agency across K-12 classrooms, providing paid professional development for teachers, and implementing the "We the People" civics curriculum supported by the Indiana Bar Foundation. An official public launch event is scheduled for January 19.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational update; no board vote required.

01:23:40 Reading Futures Tutoring Program Update

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dave Stevenson, Founder of Reading Futures; accompanied by Heidi White.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Stevenson provided a progress update on the targeted, high-dosage virtual reading intervention services currently deployed for 60 struggling readers across Southview, Longfellow, and Grissom elementary schools (focusing on grades 1 and 2). The program utilizes specialized curricula (such as Hill RAP and RAVO) and provides weekly progress reports to teachers and parents.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational update; no board vote required.

01:28:47 Superintendent & Administrative Updates

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. Lee Ann Kwiatkowski, Superintendent.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Dr. Kwiatkowski provided updates on upcoming administrative items:
 - Multi-factor authentication (MFA) roll-out for all MCS email accounts (including board members) required by the insurance provider.
 - An upcoming student immunization push targeting 300+ students behind on required shots, with an exclusion deadline set for December 5.
 - A new partnership with American Fidelity offering one-on-one employee benefit reviews.
 - The upcoming Community Sing event on December 4.
 - The United Way campaign closing on November 18.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational update; no board vote required.

01:36:04 Consent Agenda Approval

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Administration / Financial Department.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Review of donations, including coats and school supplies from the Knights of Columbus, Jeff Huff, Staples, and Ron Crouch, alongside support for the Southside Panther Pantry.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.

01:37:15 Financial Report & Rainy Day Fund Transfers

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad Jerome, Chief Financial Officer.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Jerome presented the October financial report, noting an ending cash balance of approximately \$33.8 million and receipt of updated state basic grant revenue reflecting an enrollment count of 4,861 students.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:**
 - Financial Report: Approved by Voice Vote [01:39:17](#).
 - Permission to transfer up to \$3.8 million of unobligated education funds into the Rainy Day Fund by December 31: Approved by Voice Vote [01:40:07](#).
 - Authorization for CFO to execute routine year-end budget transfers: Approved by Voice Vote [01:40:52](#).

[01:40:56](#) Construction Bids for Stadium Project

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad Jerome / Architectural Representatives.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Mr. Jerome presented the Guaranteed Maximum Price (GMP) construction bid packages totaling \$5.144 million for the stadium project, noting that the project was phased due to higher-than-expected costs in certain areas (such as restrooms/concessions).
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [01:44:04](#).

[01:44:09](#) Statutory Public Hearing: Additional Appropriation from Rainy Day Fund

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad Jerome.
- **Deliberation Summary:** The presiding officer formally opened a public hearing to consider an additional appropriation of \$1,000,000 from the Rainy Day Fund for unexpected capital repairs and/or state loan paybacks. Mr. Jerome clarified that the funding is already in hand and does not raise tax rates or debt, but provides expenditure authority.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** Presiding officer called for public comment multiple times; no members of the public stepped forward to speak.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:**
 - Close Public Hearing: Approved by Voice Vote [01:46:23](#).
 - Additional Appropriation Resolution (\$1,000,000 from Rainy Day Fund): Approved by Voice Vote [01:47:16](#).

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

(No members of the general public signed up or spoke during the general public comment period.)

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** Board members noted upcoming student events, including the National Honor Society inductions and student recognitions.
 - **Adjournment:** 01:47:27 Motion to adjourn made by Mr. Heater, seconded by Mr. Low, and approved by voice vote. Meeting adjourned.
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